

SECTION A (Source-Based Case Study)

Answer all questions.

Living in a Diverse Society

Study the Background Information and the sources carefully, and then answer all the questions.

You may use any of the sources to help you answer the questions, in addition to those sources which you are told to use. In answering the questions, you should use your knowledge of the issue to help you interpret and evaluate the sources.

1 Study Source A.

What can you infer about Singlish from this source? Explain your answer using details from the source. [5]

2 Study Source B.

Why do you think the Singaporean's view of Singlish was published? Explain your answer. [6]

3 Study Source C.

Does this source prove that people's attitudes towards Singlish are negative? Explain your answer. [7]

4 Study Sources D and E.

How different are these two sources? Explain your answer. [7]

5 How far do the sources in this case study show that Singlish helps people appreciate diversity? Explain your answer. [10]

Does Singlish help people appreciate diversity?

BACKGROUND INFORMATION

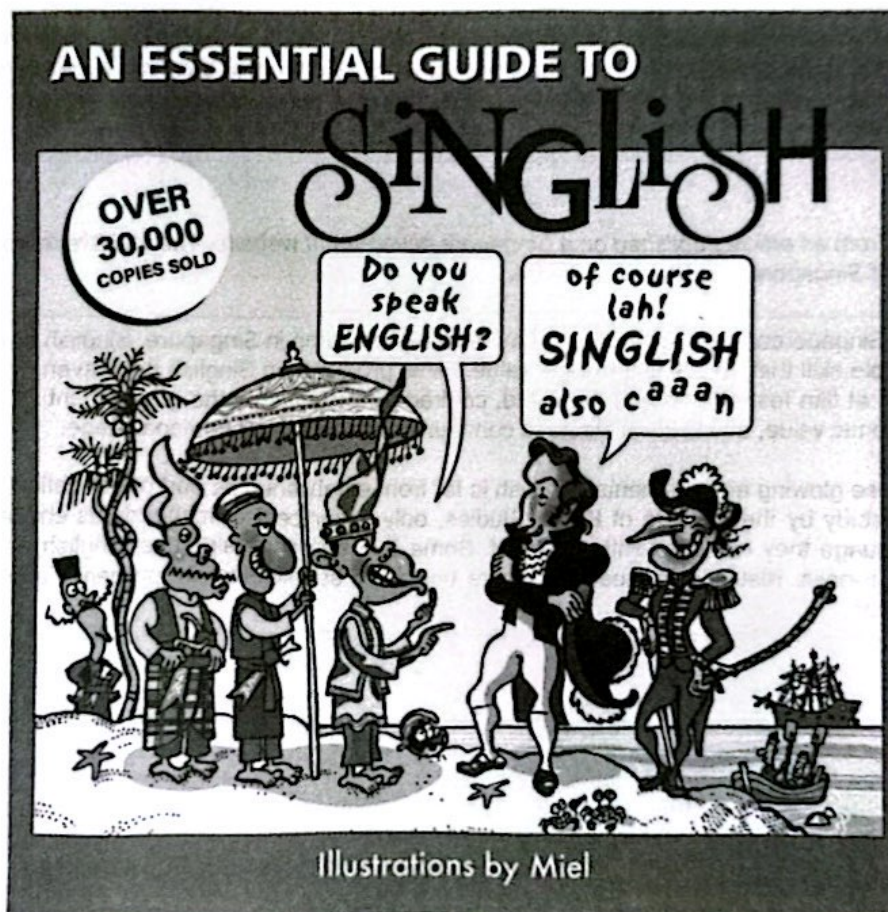
Read this carefully. It may help you to answer some of the questions.

Singlish is an informal form of English language that is spoken in Singapore. It includes words and phrases from various languages spoken in Singapore, including Malay and Tamil, and Chinese dialects Hokkien and Cantonese. Singlish is widely spoken and understood, and although it is not considered the formal language of the country, it remains an important part of Singaporean identity and culture. It is especially valuable for bonding different groups of people in a diverse society.

However, Singlish is seen as a hindrance to Standard English proficiency and a barrier to effective communication in international settings, affecting Singapore's global competitiveness. Singlish is also associated with a lack of education and social status. Despite these perceptions, Singlish continues to be celebrated by both locals and foreigners.

Study the sources below to assess whether Singlish helps people appreciate diversity.

Source A: The cover page of a book on Singlish. This book was first published in Singapore in 2003. The characters on the right of the cover picture are saying 'Yes of course! I also speak Singlish.'



Source B: From an article published on a Singapore news website, August 2020. This website focuses on human interest stories and speaking out on social issues.

When abroad, it is common for Singaporeans to recognise other Singaporeans instantly when we hear phrases like 'can meh' or 'cannot lah'. This is proof that Singlish as a language forms part of our identity as Singaporeans.

When my Singaporean friends based overseas return to Singapore, I cannot be prouder to welcome them back home with a healthy dose of Singlish. Seeing someone dear will always be a happy moment but hearing Singlish and chatting in a familiar language after being away for so long, is just as touching. It is in those moments where I strongly feel this language that binds all Singaporeans is worthy of celebration. Or as they say in Singlish: 'This one confirm must celebrate lah!'

Source C: From an article written by a local university student, published in the university's newsletter, November 2020.

It's fair to say that Singaporeans are not proud of Singlish. We may teach our friends from all over the world how to speak Singlish. Yet Singaporeans, especially those with higher levels of education, make fun of those unable to switch back to Standard English. We believe that people who speak Singlish are somehow less intelligent than us, the educated elite.

That some can speak only Singlish is not a criticism against them. In fact, I think they are more in tune with their heritage than any of us who sneer at them. So the next time you hear someone slip a *lah* into conversation, think twice before labelling them as uneducated. Better yet, just embrace Singlish *lah*.

Source D: From an article published on a Singapore government website. The website features stories of Singapore's journey as a nation.

With more Singaporeans going abroad and more foreigners living in Singapore, Singlish has become a transferable skill that non-Singaporeans value. Films produced in Singlish have even managed to win awards at film festivals around the world, contradicting claims by the government that Singlish lacks economic value, and is an obstacle to communication on an international stage.

Despite these glowing achievements, Singlish is far from established as part of our national identity. In a 2018 study by the Institute of Policy Studies, only 8 per cent of respondents chose Singlish as the language they identified with the most. Some Singaporeans also use Singlish as a test of Singaporean-ness, resulting in those who were unable to speak Singlish 'properly' labelled 'fake' Singaporeans.

Source E: From an article titled 'Don't play, play – Singlish is studied around the globe', published by a Singapore-based newsagency, February 2017.

From Italy and Germany to Japan, at least seven universities around the world have used Singlish as a case study in linguistics* courses over the past decade. This is on top of more than 40 academics outside of Singapore who have written books or papers on Singlish as part of their research.

An assistant professor at the University of Freiburg in Germany has introduced Singlish in classes since 2007. These include courses he conducted at Britain's Oxford University and University of Lausanne in Switzerland. Snippets from films such as *Ah Boys to Men* and *Singapore Dreaming* are used in his classes. Ms Celia, an undergraduate, said she had a chance to learn about Singapore culture through the class on Singlish.

* linguistics is the scientific study of language

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Printed and published by Singapore Asia Publishers Pte Ltd

(2023)4

N(A) Humanities (Social Studies)